



The Number Stops Moving First

Weekly Logged Hours Before and After a Learner Driver Reaches the Mandatory Minimum

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The problem

Learner-driver logbook apps certify that a state-mandated minimum of supervised practice has occurred before a practical test. Little is known about what happens to the practice itself once the app confirms the number has been reached.

Research questions

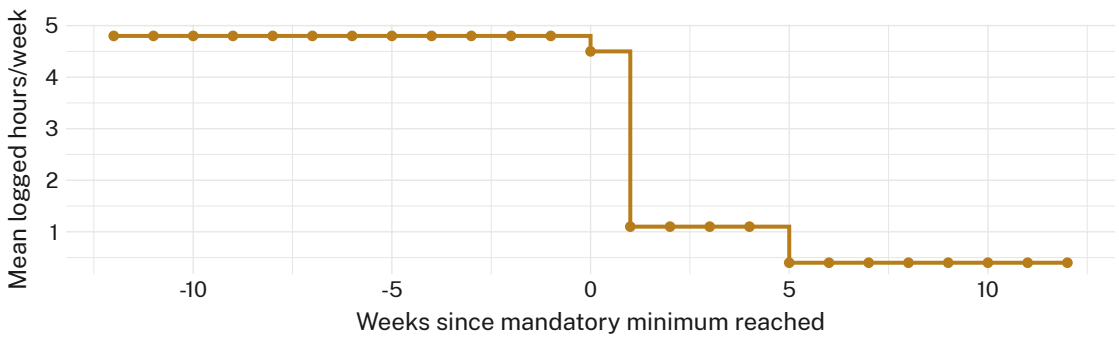
- Track weekly logged hours before and after a learner crosses the mandatory minimum
- Test whether the logging rate recovers as the practical test date approaches
- Compare the pattern across driving schools sharing one logbook app

Study design

- 118 logbooks · 3 partner driving schools · 34-week observation window
- Weekly logged-hours totals matched against each learner's booked test date
- Night-hours sub-requirement tracked separately as a control

What we found

Logged hours fall by three-quarters within five weeks of the mandatory minimum being reached, and hold there until a test is booked. The night-hours sub-requirement, reached later on average, shows the same pattern on its own delayed schedule.



Mean weekly logged hours across the cohort held at 4.8 in the twelve weeks before the mandatory 100-hour threshold was reached, and fell to 0.4 within five weeks of it, consistent across all three participating driving schools (n = 118 logbooks, tracked October 2025–June 2026).

Implications

The logbook was built to evidence practice, not motivate it, and the cohort's own behaviour treats the two as the same instrument. Families describe “finishing the logbook” as a milestone independent of the test date, sometimes months apart. Next: testing whether a state that decouples the night-hours sub-requirement from the total produces a second, smaller step of its own.

Selected references

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“The logbook says done. The lessons mostly stop with it.”

Weekly logged hours fall by three-quarters within five weeks of the mandatory minimum.